

I2C notes (240lx spr26)



I2C

Medium complexity device with the usual patterns:

- bunch of magic addresses, bunch of magic constants
- passive definitional voice when you just want an example.
- errata.
- a couple hardware-is-not-software gotchas.
- but, also: you can always bit bang it (and you have/will)

Solve the above, get the big prize: no more magic.

- all code from IMU lab = yours.

We already have UART: why another protocol?

Property	UART	I2C
Speed	Pretty slow	Pretty slow
Wires	2 wires: tx , rx	2 wires: SDA , SCL
Topology	1 sender / 1 receiver	Many slave devices
Addressing	Point-to-point	~7-bit addresses
Timing	Tight timing: receiver must know when to sample after start bit	Loose timing: use SCL to know when SDA is valid
Duplex	Full duplex	Half duplex
Collision	No collision	Can detect collision by reading SDA after sending

Key difference: i2c use "open-drain" to "send" 1.

- UART writes 1 for 1, 0 for 0.
 - Easy. Obvious. But not the only way to do this!
 - Unfortunately; doesn't work for I2C
- Problem: device(s) and master share data line (SDA)
 - If both device and master write 1 = short circuit.
 - "Just don't do that" is harder than it looks.
 - So instead it uses a pullup trick

Open Drain: How two 1's don't cause a short circuit

- SDA has a permanent pullup resistor to 3.3V (always on)
- Each device's pin is EITHER:
 - Input: transistor off, pin is floating.
Pullup wins = line reads as 1.
 - Output low: transistor on, pin connected to ground.
Pullup loses (can't overcome the transistor) = line reads as 0.
- **Devices NEVER drive the line high.** No one ever pushes 3.3V.
Going high = releasing, letting pullup do it.

Result: wired-AND behavior

- No one driving ==> pullup wins ==> reads as digital 1
- One or more devices pulling low ==> reads as digital 0
- Multiple devices can pull low simultaneously ==> no conflict.
- Collision detection: after releasing (to send 1), read line back.
If it reads 0, someone else is pulling ==> collision.
- Not crucial, but interesting behavior:
 - low device addresses "win" collisions.
 - collisions not destructive (one winner).

Easiest way to see: use GPIO to do loopback send

Standard loopback

```
output("obvious standard loopback test\n");
gpio_set_output(out);
gpio_set_input(in);
for (int i = 0; i < N; i++) {
    gpio_write(out, 1);
    if (!gpio_read(in))
        panic("missing jumper from %d to %d\n", in, out);
    output("%d: 1\n", i);

    gpio_write(out, 0);
    if (gpio_read(in))
        panic("missing jumper from %d to %d\n", in, out);
    output("%d: 0\n", i);
}
```

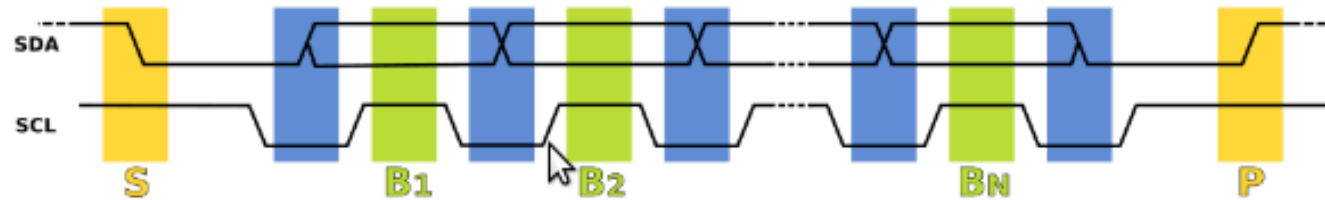

"Open drain" loopback

```
output("pullup loopback test\n");
gpio_write(out,0);
gpio_set_pullup(out);
for (int i = 0; i < N; i++) {
    // write 1
    gpio_set_input(out); // connects pin to pullup
    delay_us(1);         // chase why for fun :)
    if (!gpio_read(in))
        panic("missing jumper from %d to %d?\n", in,out);
    output("%d: 1 -> 1\n", i);

    // write 0
    gpio_set_output(out); // disconnect from pullup
    gpio_write(out, 0);   // ~instantaneous: no delay
    if (gpio_read(in))
        panic("missing jumper from %d to %d?\n", in,out);
    output("%d: 0 -> 0\n", i);
}
```

i2c timing

Timing diagram [\[edit \]](#)



1. Data transfer is initiated with a *start* condition (S) signalled by SDA being pulled low while SCL stays high.
2. SCL is pulled low, and SDA sets the first data bit level while keeping SCL low (during blue bar time).
3. The data is sampled (received) when SCL rises for the first bit (B1). For a bit to be valid, SDA must not change between a rising edge of SCL and the subsequent falling edge (the entire green bar time).
4. This process repeats, SDA transitioning while SCL is low, and the data being read while SCL is high (B2 through Bn).
5. The final bit is followed by a clock pulse, during which SDA is pulled low in preparation for the *stop* bit.
6. A *stop* condition (P) is signalled when SCL rises, followed by SDA rising.

To avoid false marker detection, there is a minimum delay between the SCL falling edge and changing SDA, and between changing SDA and the SCL rising edge. The minimum delay time is dependent upon the data transfer rate in use. Note that an I²C message containing n data bits (including acknowledgements) contains $n + 1$ clock pulses.

i2c data timing

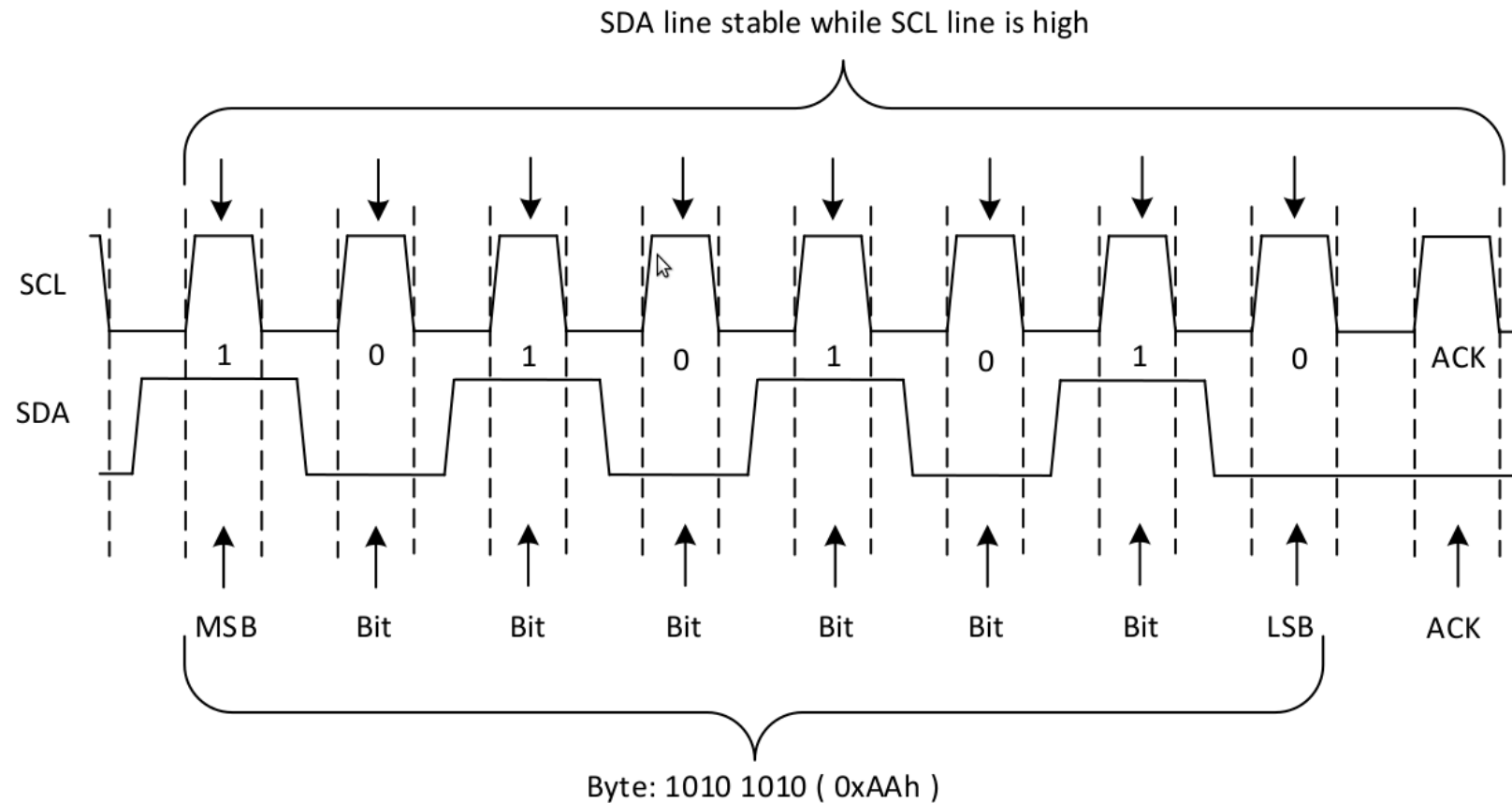


Figure 6. Example of Single Byte Data Transfer

i2c start-stop timing

2.1.1 START and STOP Conditions

I²C communication with this device is initiated by the master sending a START condition and terminated by the master sending a STOP condition. A high-to-low transition on the SDA line while the SCL is high defines a START condition. A low-to-high transition on the SDA line while the SCL is high defines a STOP condition.

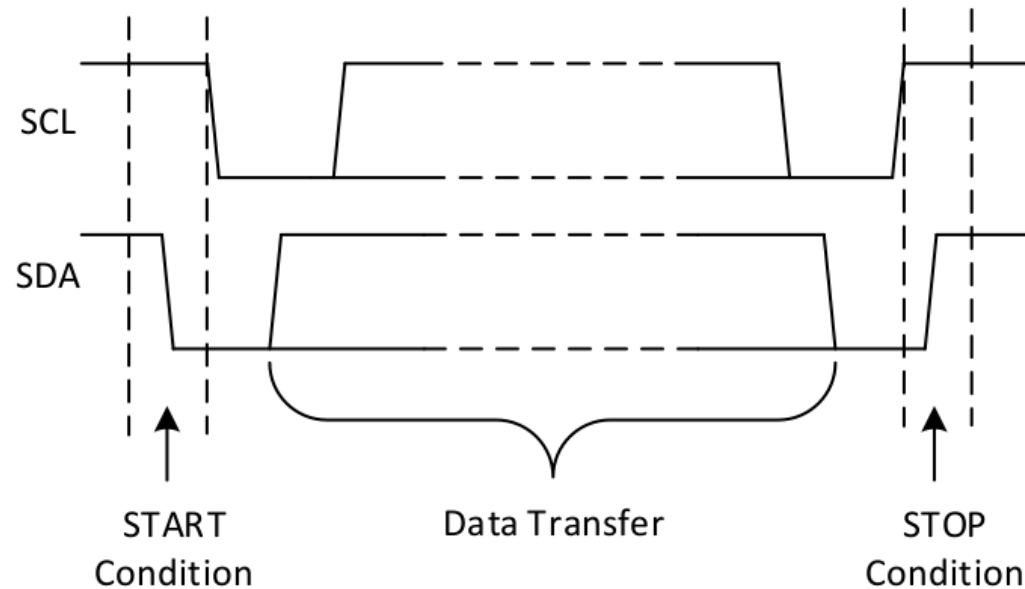


Figure 5. Example of START and STOP Condition

Setting GPIO pins: i2c



BCM2835 ARM Peripherals

6.2 Alternative Function Assignments

Every GPIO pin can carry an alternate function. Up to 6 alternate function are available but not every pin has that many alternate functions. The table below gives a quick over view.

	Pull	ALT0	ALT1	ALT2	ALT3	ALT4	ALT5
GPIO0	High	SDA0	SA5	<reserved>			
GPIO1	High	SCL0	SA4	<reserved>			
GPIO2	High	SDA1	SA3	<reserved>			
GPIO3	High	SCL1	SA2	<reserved>			
GPIO4	High	GPCLK0	SA1	<reserved>			ARM_TDI
GPIO5	High	GPCLK1	SA0	<reserved>			ARM_TDO
GPIO6	High	GPCLK2	SOE_N / SE	<reserved>			ARM_RTCK
GPIO7	High	SPI0_CE1_N	SWE_N / SBW_N	<reserved>			
GPIO8	High	SPI0_CE0_N	SD0	<reserved>			
GPIO9	Low	SPI0_MISO	SD1	<reserved>			
GPIO10	Low	SPI0_MOSI	SD2	<reserved>			
GPIO11	Low	SPI0_SCLK	SD3	<reserved>			
GPIO12	Low	PWM0	SD4	<reserved>			ARM_TMS
GPIO13	Low	PWM1	SD5	<reserved>			ARM_TCK

standard i/o device Qs (echoes of UART)

1. How to turn off? (why?)
2. How to configure? (today: speed)
 - How to clear old data? (Why?)
 - What can we ignore? (Everyone's favorite!)
 - How to sanity check? (initial values, readback, xcheck)
 - What other devices do we need? (Speed \implies usually > 1)
3. How to turn on?
4. RX: Has data? How to get?
5. TX: Has space? How to send?

Now: take a partner and find the page numbers

Algorithm:

1. Go through each register in order (so don't miss).
2. Get the page number, bit position
3. Get ordering rules.

Open Drain: How to make two 1's not = short circuit

- To send a 1:
 - SDA: use "pullup resistor" to connect SDA to 3.3v
 - Reads as logical 1.
 - So: by default, doing nothing = 1. (no short circuit)
- To send a 0:
 - i. Switch to output (disconnects pullup)
 - ii. Write 0.
- Result:
 - if no one uses it, reads digital 1.
 - if ≥ 1 using: SDA pulled low, reads as digital 0

!!! if multiple devices, if 0, all read 0. If 1, all read 1.